



Quality management — Customer satisfaction — Guidelines for dispute resolution external to organizations

(ISO 10003:2007)

Qualitätsmanagement — Kundenzufriedenheit — Leitfaden für Konfliktlösung
außerhalb von Organisationen
(ISO 10003:2007)

Management de la qualité — Satisfaction des clients — Lignes directrices pour la
résolution des disputes d'organismes externes
(ISO 10003:2007)

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National Foreword

The International Standards given in [clause 2](#) and under [bibliography](#) are also available as Austrian Standards (ÖNORM):

ÖNORM EN ISO 9000, *Qualitätsmanagementsysteme — Grundlagen und Begriffe (ISO 9000:2005)*
(mehrsprachige Fassung: de/en/fr)

ÖNORM EN ISO 9001, *Qualitätsmanagementsysteme – Anforderungen (ISO 9001:2000)*

ÖNORM EN ISO 9004, *Qualitätsmanagementsysteme – Leitfaden zur Leistungsverbesserung (ISO 9004:2000)*

ÖNORM ISO 10001, *Qualitätsmanagement — Kundenzufriedenheit — Leitfaden für Verhaltenskodizes für Organisationen (ISO 10001:2007)*

ÖNORM ISO 10002, *Qualitätsmanagement — Kundenzufriedenheit — Leitfaden für die Behandlung von Reklamationen in Organisationen (ISO 10002:2004)*

Special attention shall be given to the provisions on arbitration in the Austrian civil process order (Zivilprozessordnung), RGBl. Nr. 113/1895, as amended, § 577 to § 618 and to the federal law on mediation in cases of civil law (Zivilrechts-Mediations-Gesetz) BGBl. I Nr. 29/2003, as amended.

**Quality management — Customer
satisfaction — Guidelines for dispute
resolution external to organizations**

*Management de la qualité — Satisfaction du client — Lignes directrices
relatives à la résolution externe de conflits aux organismes*



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Foreword

ISO (the International Organization for Standardization) is a worldwide federation of national standards bodies (ISO member bodies). The work of preparing International Standards is normally carried out through ISO technical committees. Each member body interested in a subject for which a technical committee has been established has the right to be represented on that committee. International organizations, governmental and non-governmental, in liaison with ISO, also take part in the work. ISO collaborates closely with the International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC) on all matters of electrotechnical standardization.

International Standards are drafted in accordance with the rules given in the ISO/IEC Directives, Part 2.

The main task of technical committees is to prepare International Standards. Draft International Standards adopted by the technical committees are circulated to the member bodies for voting. Publication as an International Standard requires approval by at least 75 % of the member bodies casting a vote.

Attention is drawn to the possibility that some of the elements of this document may be the subject of patent rights. ISO shall not be held responsible for identifying any or all such patent rights.

ISO 10003 was prepared by Technical Committee ISO/TC 176, *Quality management and quality assurance*, Subcommittee SC 3, *Supporting technologies*.

Introduction

0.1 General

This International Standard provides guidance for organizations to plan, design, develop, operate, maintain and improve effective and efficient external dispute resolution for product-related complaints. Dispute resolution gives an avenue of redress when organizations do not remedy a complaint internally. Most complaints can be resolved successfully within the organization, without the need for further time-consuming and more adversarial procedures.

NOTE 1 Organizations are encouraged to develop an effective and efficient internal complaints-handling process consistent with ISO 10002.

There are different methods for resolving disputes and different terms used to describe them. These methods are facilitative, advisory or determinative (see [Annex A](#)). Each method can be used by itself or the methods can be used in sequence.

This International Standard can be used to

- a) design a dispute-resolution process and decide when to offer dispute resolution to complainants, and
- b) select a dispute-resolution provider (hereinafter referred to as “provider”; see [3.9](#)) that is able to meet an organization’s specific needs and expectations.

NOTE 2 Providers from the public and private sectors can take various forms around the world, including industry-sector specific associations, ombudsmen and multi-sector associations.

While this International Standard is directed towards organizations, providers can also benefit from knowing what guidance is being given to organizations. Providers can also use the guidance in their dispute-resolution process.

Organizations are encouraged to plan, design, develop, operate, maintain and improve a dispute-resolution process in conjunction with a customer satisfaction code of conduct and internal complaints-handling process, and to integrate them with the organization’s quality or other management systems.

This International Standard can assist individuals and organizations in evaluating the effectiveness, efficiency and fairness of an organization’s dispute-resolution process. Implementation of this International Standard can:

- provide flexible dispute resolution that, in comparison with court-based processes, can be less expensive, easier and quicker, especially in disputes across borders;
- help to enhance customer satisfaction and loyalty;
- provide a benchmark against which individuals and organizations can evaluate claims by organizations and providers that they operate in an effective, efficient and fair manner;
- help to inform potential users of dispute resolution about the conditions of access, cost and the legal consequences;
- enhance the ability of an organization to identify and eliminate causes of disputes;
- improve the way complaints and disputes are handled in the organization;
- provide additional information that can contribute to improvement of the organization’s processes and products;
- improve the organization’s reputation or avoid damage to it;

- improve domestic and international competitiveness;
- provide confidence of fair and consistent treatment of disputes throughout the global marketplace.

Note that external dispute resolution can be the subject of statutory and regulatory requirements.

NOTE 3 Terminology used in connection with dispute resolution is not always the same throughout the world. [Annex A](#) provides a glossary of some of the equivalent terms.

0.2 Relationship with ISO 9001 and ISO 9004

This International Standard is compatible with ISO 9001 and ISO 9004 and supports the objectives of these two standards through the effective and efficient application of a dispute-resolution process. This International Standard can also be used independently of ISO 9001 and ISO 9004.

ISO 9001 specifies requirements for a quality management system that can be used for internal application by organizations, or for certification, or for contractual purposes. The dispute-resolution process described in this International Standard (ISO 10003) can be used as an element of a quality management system. This International Standard is not intended for certification or for contractual purposes.

ISO 9004 provides guidance on continual improvement of performance regarding quality management systems. The use of this International Standard (ISO 10003) can further enhance performance in resolving disputes with complainants and increase the satisfaction of customers, complainants and other interested parties. It can also facilitate the continual improvement of the quality of processes and products based on feedback from customers, complainants and other interested parties.

NOTE Apart from customers and complainants, other interested parties can include suppliers, industry associations and their members, consumer organizations, relevant government agencies, personnel, owners and others who are affected by the dispute-resolution process.

0.3 Relationship with ISO 10001 and ISO 10002

This International Standard is compatible with ISO 10001 and ISO 10002. These three standards can be used either independently or in conjunction with each other. When used together, ISO 10001, ISO 10002 and this International Standard can be part of a broader and integrated framework for enhanced customer satisfaction through codes of conduct, complaints handling and dispute resolution (see [Annex B](#)).

ISO 10001 contains guidance on customer satisfaction codes of conduct for organizations. Such codes, in setting out what customers can expect from the organization and its products, can decrease the likelihood of problems arising and can eliminate causes of complaints and disputes. When complaints and disputes do arise, the existence of codes of conduct can assist the parties in understanding customer expectations and the organization's attempts to meet those expectations.

ISO 10002 contains guidance on the internal handling of product-related complaints. This International Standard (ISO 10003) can be used when complaints are not resolved internally.

0.4 Statements regarding conformity

This International Standard is designed to be used solely as a guidance document. Where all applicable guidance provided in this International Standard has been implemented, statements that a dispute-resolution process is based on that guidance can be made.

However, any statements claiming or implying conformity to this International Standard are inconsistent with this International Standard, and it is therefore inappropriate to make such statements.

NOTE Statements claiming or implying conformity to this International Standard are thus inappropriate in any promotional and communication material, such as press releases, advertisements, marketing brochures, videos, staff announcements, logos, slogans and catch lines for diverse media, ranging from print and broadcasting to Internet and multi-media applications, to product labels, signs and banners.

